

Catherina Ngongni Kuetezang

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SUMMARY

- Passionate about AI ethics, AI use, AI policy, and AI-driven solutions. As co-founder of the AI Literacy Society, I promote AI education and ethical AI use in academia and workplaces.
- I have experience in mentorship, youth-led participatory research and AI ethics and governance, gained through leadership roles and collaborations with other societies at the University of Pretoria.
- I am committed to bridging the AI knowledge gap in Africa and equipping students with ethical AI principles.
- Gained valuable experience in effective training of over 700+ university students on the use of Perplexity AI in academia as a perplexity campus strategist, Lead in South Africa.

EDUCATION

University Of Pretoria – Pretoria, South Africa **February 2024 – Current**
Master's (MSc) Bioinformatics,
Majors: Research project – In silico analysis of pathogen on maize disease

ALX South Africa – Pretoria, South Africa **February 2024 – May 2025**
Data Analysis & Data Science,
Majors: SQL, Data Visualization, Python, Regression, NLP and Classification, Unsupervised Learning and AWS foundation

University Of Pretoria – Pretoria, South Africa **February 2023 – December 2023**
Bachelor of Science (Bioinformatics Honours),
Majors: Statistics, Bioinformatics, Molecular and Cell Biology

University Of Pretoria – Pretoria, South Africa **February 2020 – December 2022**
Bachelor of Science (Human Genetics),
Majors: Biostatics, Mathematics, Analytical chemistry and physics, Biochemistry, Genetics and Physiology

WORK EXPERIENCE

Perplexity Campus Strategist Lead South Africa **January 2025 – June 2025**
Perplexity AI (Remote)

- Collaborated with Perplexity Campus strategists in different South African universities on promoting Perplexity AI use.
- Educate students at university and conferences on the ethical use of Perplexity AI and its application in academia and research

Junior Information Assistant **February 2025 – Current**

University of Pretoria (part-time) – Research library, Hatfield, South Africa

- Providing technical assistance to Masters and PhD students and AI tools for research writing
- Assisting with formatting documents, providing information, and using statistical tools for research purposes

Academic Invigilator & Biochemistry marker/tutor **May 2024 – May 2025**

University of Pretoria (part-time) – Hatfield, South Africa

- Ensuring more than 350+ undergraduate students uphold and follow the test/exam rules and regulations
- Monitoring and assisting students during and after tests/exams.
- Tutored & marked semester tests, exams, sick exams, and supplementary exams for 700+ second-year students.

Chairperson of SOS Academic Society **March 2024 – August 2024**

University of Pretoria (part-time) – Hatfield, South Africa

- Provided leadership and ensured the executive committee members fulfilled their responsibilities for society's success.
- Collaborated with +2 societies and interacted with students within the society.
- Successfully hosted a transformative academic exclusion event that assisted more than 30 students and reinstated more than 25 students into the university.

VOLUNTEER ACTIVITIES

Academic Appeals Assistant

December 2023 - Current

Willmore Youth Foundation (Volunteer) – Hatfield, South Africa

- Providing more than 70% of students with guidelines to structure their appeal letters to be reinstated.
- Proofreading and editing academic appeal letters for first-year, second-year, and final-year students.

Mentor

March 2021 – December 2024

Nerina residence (volunteer) – Hatfield, South Africa

- Mentored 10+ first-year students in my academic residence, provided guidance and academic and emotional support
- Mentored 15+ first-year students from the STARS Mentorship Programme, tutored, provided guidance and support.

Outreach programs

January 2019 - Current

Messengers Project Group (volunteer) – Benoni, South Africa

- Packing and distributing food packs to 50+ homeless individuals.
- Organizing routine visits every 6 months to 5+ orphanages and old age homes with food parcels.

Academic Tutor

March 2019 - December 2020

100KidsToVarsity (volunteer) – Hatfield, South Africa

- Visited 5+ high schools, provided tutoring to 45+ learners on challenging subjects.
- Gave motivational speeches and shared my knowledge and experiences with 100+ learners, contributing to more than 50% of students improving their academic performance.

AWARDS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

International modelling and epidemiology summer school – University of Pretoria | obtained in 2024

- For completing and actively participating in the summer school

Academic appeals assistant – Willmore Youth Foundation Society | obtained in 2024 and 2025

- Assisting with guiding students on required documents, reviewing and delegating appeal letters to volunteers
- Assisting students within the society with their appeals for the 2023/2024 academic year

Golden Key Award – University of Pretoria | obtained in 2023

- Top 15% of the Natural Science and Agriculture Faculty with an average of 75%

Merit Award – University of Pretoria | obtained in 2023

- Top 15% of the Natural Science and Agriculture Faculty with an average of 70%

Academic guidance certificate – Attainment Institute | obtained in 2022

- To educate Matrices on careers and opportunities at the university.

SKILLS

- Proficient in Microsoft skills, including MS Word, Excel, and PowerPoint.
- Coding language Proficient in R Programming language, Python, BioPython programming language, SQL database language, and Linux operating system.
- Data collection, clean up, sequencing, analysis, and visualization.
- Braiding hair and designing manicures and pedicures.
- Coordinate Projects, draft reports, and do public speaking and presentations.
- Quantitative and Qualitative research skills

INTERESTS

Chess competitions,	Women Empowerment	Teaching and mentoring
Business Novels	Youth Empowerment	AI Mentor

LANGUAGES

English - Fluent	Setswana - conversational	Portuguese - Beginner
French - Fluent	Afrikaans - conversational	